

JOHNDAVID WHALEN

Former U.S. Navy Lieutenant | Strategic Advisor | AI Strategy & Implementation

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Lisbon, Portugal • U.S. and EU Open Travel Access • Available for International Travel

PROFILE

JohnDavid Whalen partners with CEOs, senior executives, and cross-functional teams to turn strategy into disciplined execution and guide organizations through operational change.

His career has crossed military operations, entrepreneurship, real estate, product development, and AI-enabled systems. Across diverse industries, JohnDavid has repeatedly demonstrated an ability to understand complex environments quickly, identify what matters, align people and resources, and move work from concept to completion.

That approach was forged as a U.S. Naval Officer, where preparation, accountability, teamwork, adaptability, and sound judgment under pressure were daily requirements. He now applies those principles to organizations confronting technological, operational, and commercial change.

CORE CAPABILITIES

Disciplined Execution • Operational Leadership • Team Alignment • Systems Thinking • Decision-Making Under Pressure • AI Strategy & Workflow Design • Strategic Communication • Cross-Functional Collaboration

LEADERSHIP FOUNDATION

UNITED STATES NAVY | Lieutenant | 2000–2005

Served as a Surface Warfare Officer, Force Protection Officer, and METOC/Oceanographer with responsibility for navigation, engineering oversight, operational leadership, intelligence coordination, and force protection. Led in high-consequence environments requiring rigorous preparation, clear communication, rapid adaptation, and individual accountability. Held TS/SCI security clearance.

SELECTED EXPERIENCE

SYF CONSULTING LLC | Cultural Strategist & Futurist | 2021–Present

Advises founders, investors, and development teams on cultural strategy, experiential design, emerging ventures, urban transformation, and AI-enabled positioning.

REAL ESTATE STRATEGY & INVESTMENT | eXp Realty Portugal / Whalen REI | 2001–Present

Invests in and manages residential and commercial real estate across U.S. and international markets. Increased an international portfolio by more than 400% over the past decade through long-term asset allocation and value-creation strategies. Designs AI-enabled workflows and operating systems for real estate professionals, including automation, agent operations, and client acquisition.

AGILE MODULARITY | Co-Founder, Director of Development | 2020–2022

Directed development of modular medical and housing concepts, including negative-pressure containment systems and scalable transitional-housing solutions.

ADDITIONAL EXPERIENCE | Media, Design & Creative Development | 2005–2024

Experience in film production, narrative development, brand strategy, lighting design, and residential and commercial design.

EDUCATION & CREDENTIALS

United States Naval Academy — B.S., Oceanography, Chemical & Physical

U.S. Naval War College • Miami Ad School — Brand Strategy

Antioch University — Full Stack Web Development

U.S. Navy — Certified Auxiliary Steam Engineer